

Woodpecker Idea Helps Bike Helmet Score Top Safety Grade

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A Vancouver company called Pikio Labs made a bike helmet that scored best in **Virginia Tech's** safety tests. The design was inspired by **woodpeckers**.

The tests give **STAR ratings**. Lower scores are better. The Pikio Si **Oblik** helmet scored 4.61, better than the old top score of 6.82.

Founder Daniel Abram says the **foam** inside is split into sections that can flex or come apart in a hard crash. That helps with both straight hits and twisting forces.

The helmet costs \$379 because it has many small parts about 80 instead of about 8 to 10. If a helmet is badly crashed, it must be replaced. Pikio studies returned helmets to learn more.

Word Treasure

STAR ratings -- Scores from Virginia Tech that compare helmet crash safety.

Oblik -- The Pikio helmet's special foam safety system.

woodpeckers -- Birds that inspired the helmet's impact design.

foam -- Soft material inside a helmet that absorbs crash energy.

Virginia Tech -- The university that runs these helmet safety tests.

Background you need

Bike helmets use foam to absorb energy when a rider's head hits something. Independent labs test helmets so shoppers can compare safety scores. A helmet that takes a hard crash usually needs to be replaced.

Break it down

WHO: Pikio Labs founder Daniel Abram

WHAT: Woodpecker-inspired helmet tops safety scores

WHERE: Virginia Tech STAR tests; company in Vancouver

WHY: Better crash protection for bike riders

Why it matters

Safer helmet designs can help protect kids and adults who ride bikes.

Test what you remember

1. What score did the Pikio Si Oblik get?

- ☐ (A) 6.82
- ☐ (B) 379
- ☐ (C) 4.61
- ☐ (D) 14

2. What animal inspired the design?

- ☐ (A) Giraffes
- ☐ (B) T. rex
- ☐ (C) Cats
- ☐ (D) Woodpeckers

3. In STAR ratings here, what is better?

- ☐ (A) Only red helmets
- ☐ (B) A higher score only
- ☐ (C) A lower score
- ☐ (D) No score

4. Who is the founder named?

- ☐ (A) Daniel Abram
- ☐ (B) Ashnikko
- ☐ (C) Laura Cuaya
- ☐ (D) Cora Walsh

5. About how many parts does the helmet use?

- ☐ (A) Two
- ☐ (B) About 80
- ☐ (C) Exactly four
- ☐ (D) One thousand

6. What company made the helmet?

- ☐ (A) Sotheby's
- ☐ (B) NPR
- ☐ (C) Pikio Labs
- ☐ (D) NASA

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Daniel Abram: Explains that foam sections can flex or come apart in a hard crash.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):